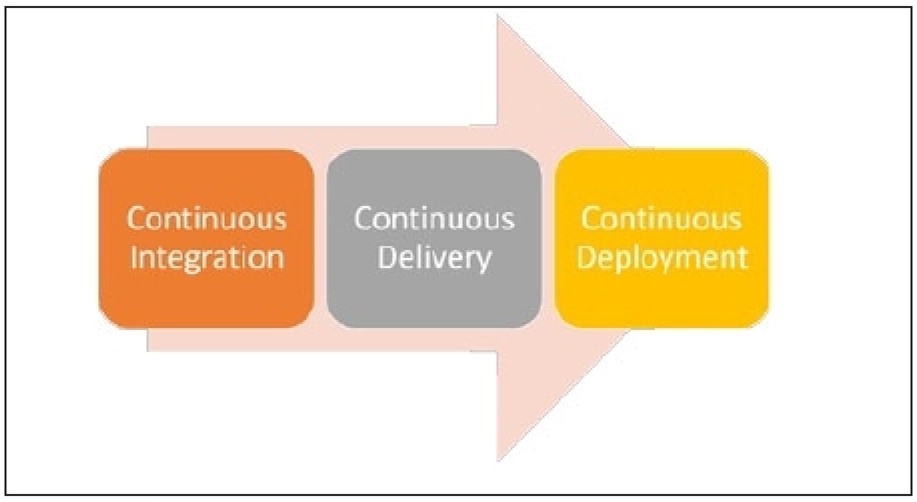

Figure 4: CI/CD

Figure 5: Benefits of continuous delivery

The continuous deployment phase represents activities to deploy the artifact in production environments using scripts or deployment tools. The artifact is directly deployed in production. Usually, continuous delivery is preferred to continuous deployment.

Benefits, best practices and challenges of continuous delivery

Success and failure are both equally important during digital and cultural transformation activities. Let's understand some of the benefits of continuous delivery from Figure 5.

Figure 6: Best practices of continuous delivery

The best practices that make it easy to implement continuous delivery are shown in Figure 6.

A major challenge with continuous integration is gaining control over the environment and people's mindset.

The dev environment might be in control of the development team, yet there are specific instances when this is not the case. VDI (virtual desktop infrastructure) is given to developers to create code for an application or different components of an application. Most of the time, environments are controlled by customers and they are not willing to relinquish this due to security reasons; hence, automated deployment to all the environments might not be feasible all the time.

Cloud resources and containers are changing the game. The way cloud services are used for infrastructure as well as for the DevOps setup helps to automate deployment in different environments. END

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By: Mitesh S.

The author has written the book, 'Agile, DevOps and Cloud Computing with Microsoft Azure'. He contributes occasionally to *https://clean-clouds.com* and *https://etutorialsworld.com.*